



# St. Thomas & the Tommy Advantage

What to expect while living  
on campus!



## **Tommy Advantage Overview & Application**

**SLED  
August 2025**



# Session Overview



Learning Outside the Classroom



Introduction to Tommie Advantage Co-Curriculum



RA Role in the Tommie Advantage



Tommie Advantage Dates for Fall 2025



Wrap Up & Questions



# **3-2-1**

## **Activity:**

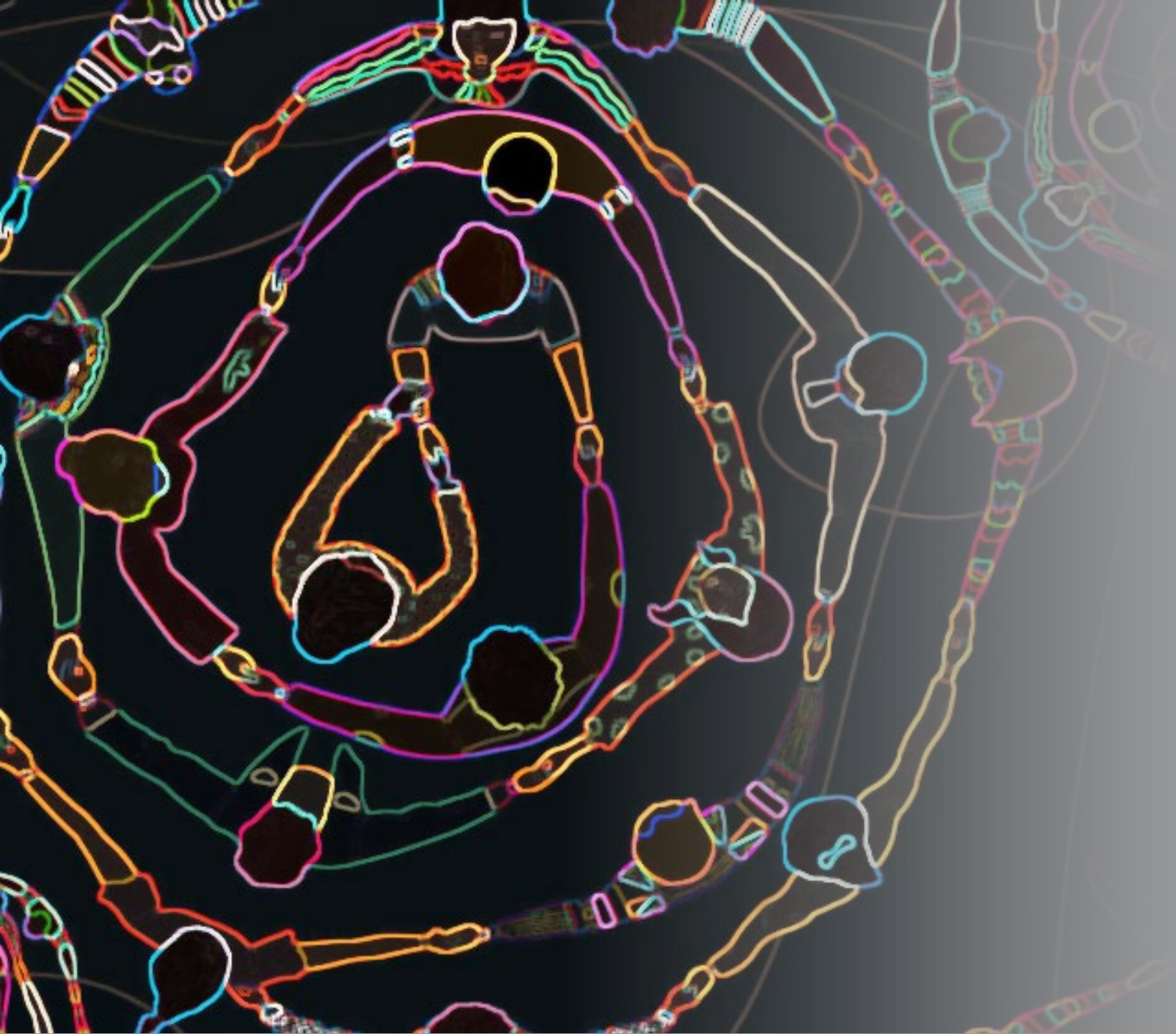
### **Learning Outside the Classroom**

**3:** things you've learned outside the classroom while at St. Thomas

**2:** people who have taught you something outside the classroom while at St. Thomas

**1:** reason you think Residence Life should focus on learning outside the classroom





# Connecting to Our “Why”

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# Why the Tommie Advantage?

## Connection & Belonging

- Meeting people
- Building relationships
- Connecting to community



## Skills for Success

- Resolving conflict
- Meeting academic goals
- Communicating well

## Well-Being

- Caring for self
- Aligning values and behavior
- Balancing priorities
- Adjusting to new challenges



# Educational Priority

As a result of students' experiences at the University of St. Thomas students will become changemaking leaders who meaningfully advance the common good.



1. Self-Understanding



2. Connecting



3. Embracing Our Differences



4. Practicing Holistic Well-Being



5. Acting Wisely



# Residence Life Educational Plan

## Strategies

### HOW we Facilitate Learning

- 1:1 Conversations
- Touch Base Meetings (NEW)
- Community Meetings
- Events
- Roommate Agreement & Conflict Resolution
- Community Communications

## Sequencing

### WHEN we Facilitate Learning

- FY & SY/UD
- Academic calendar & student needs
- See Tommie Advantage Dates

## Lesson Plans

### FACILITATING Learning

- Step by step guide to facilitate learning
- Focus on one specific part of learning outcomes
- Detail of strategy, who is facilitating, how to prepare, what needs to happen after

## Assessment

### MEASURING Learning

- Did the learning happen and to what degree
- Direct and indirect
- See Rubrics



# **Lesson Plan Structure**

**Learning Strategy**

**Target Audience**

**Date & Time**

**Learning Goals & Outcome(s)**

**Strategy Level Outcome(s)**

**Additional Intended Outcome(s)**

**Rationale (the WHY)**

**Planning & Preparation**

**Facilitation Guide**

**Assessment & Reporting**



**Supervision Expectations**

# Connecting

| Learning Outcome          |                                                               | No Evidence                                                                       | Beginning                                                                                             | Middle                                                                             | Advanced                                                                              |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Students will be able to: |                                                               | can't do                                                                          | can do a little                                                                                       | can do pretty well                                                                 | add complexity                                                                        |
| 2.a                       | Identify connections with individuals and communities         | Unable to identify connections.                                                   | Describe potential connections with individuals and communities.                                      | Describe connections with individuals and communities.                             | Estimate the actions needed to maintain connections with individuals and communities. |
| 2.b                       | Demonstrate the ability to engage others with empathy         | Unable to engage others with empathy.                                             | Recognize strategies to engage others with empathy and identify situations where empathy is required. | Apply strategies to engage others with empathy.                                    | Propose strategies for others to engage with empathy in group discussions.            |
| 2.c                       | Employ strategies to navigate conflict in a healthy manner    | Unable to recognize or navigate conflict without escalation.                      | Recognize strategies to navigate conflict in a healthy manner.                                        | Employ strategies to navigate conflict without escalation.                         | Resolve conflict without escalation using a variety of strategies.                    |
| 2.d                       | Build interdependent relationships with mutual accountability | Unable to participate in interdependent relationships with mutual accountability. | Recognize strategies to build interdependent relationships with mutual accountability                 | Apply strategies to build interdependent relationships with mutual accountability. | Evaluate existing relationships for interdependence and mutual accountability.        |

# 1-Minute Writing

**Think about the best teacher or professor you've ever had.**

**What did they DO that made them a good teacher?**



# 1-Minute Writing

Think about the best teacher or professor you've ever had.

What did they DO that made them a good teacher?

Discuss at your table



# Learning is **facilitated** by **EDUCATORS**

(we'll teach you how)

**AND**  
how you think about  
**yourself** is important...





you are all  
**Peer  
Educators**



# Residence Life Tommie Advantage Dates - Fall 2025

| START DATE | END DATE | FY / SY | STRATEGY           | # | LO(s)         | TOPIC                                                                     |
|------------|----------|---------|--------------------|---|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8/8        | 8/10     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 1 | 1.a, 3.b      | Belonging in our Community (Room. Agr. Part 1)                            |
| 8/15       | 8/17     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 2 | 2.a           | Connection to New Community                                               |
| 8/19       | 8/20     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 3 | 2.d           | Introduce Important Policies for Living In Community                      |
| 8/20       | 9/14     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 4 | 2.a           | Introducing Tommie Advantage                                              |
| 8/20       | 9/14     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 5 | 2.d           | Move In & Policy Reminders, Getting Connected                             |
| 8/20       | 1/29     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 6 | 4.b           | Campus Resources                                                          |
| 8/25       | 8/25     | FY      | Comm. Comm.        | 7 | 2.a           | Excited for move in                                                       |
| 8/27       | 8/27     | FY      | Comm. Mtg.         | 1 | 2.a, 3.b      | Connections, Important Info, Instructions for Room. Agr.                  |
| 8/28       | 9/1      | FY      | Roommate Agreement | 2 | 2.a, 3.b      | Connecting, Boundaries                                                    |
| 8/28       | 8/28     | SY      | Comm. Comm.        | 7 | 2.a           | Excited for move in                                                       |
| 9/2        | 9/2      | SY      | Comm. Mtg.         | 1 | 2.a, 2.d, 3.b | Connections, Important Info, Instructions for Room. Agr., Comm. Standards |
| 9/3        | 9/7      | SY      | Roommate Agreement | 2 | 2.a, 3.b      | Connecting, Boundaries                                                    |
| 9/3        | 9/21     | FY & SY | Touch Base Mtg.    | 1 | 2.a           | Brief Roommate Check In; Connection w/ RA                                 |
| 9/15       | 10/13    | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 8 | 4.b           | Strategies for Academic Success                                           |
| 9/15       | 10/13    | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 9 | 3.b           | Communicating in Roommate Conflicts                                       |



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|------------|----------|---------|--------------------|----|----------|----------------------------------------------|
| 9/22       | 9/26     | FY & SY | Comm. Mtg.         | 2  | 2.d, 3.b | Accountability in Our Community              |
| 9/24       | 9/24     | FY & SY | Roommate Agreement | 4  | 2.a      | Roommate Relationship Check In               |
| 9/29       | 11/9     | FY & SY | 1:1 Conversation   | 1  | 2.a      | Connecting, Room. Agr. Part 3, Communication |
| 10/14      | 10/19    | FY & SY | Roommate Agreement | 6  | 2.a, 3.b | Updating Roomcompact Agreement               |
| 10/14      | 11/2     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 10 | 2.c      | Managing Conflict                            |
| 10/14      | 11/2     | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 11 | 3.b      | Engaging in Divisive Conversations           |
| 11/3       | 11/30    | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 12 | 1.a      | Reflecting on core values                    |
| 11/3       | 11/30    | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 13 | 3.b      | Strategies to Communicate Across Difference  |
| 11/10      | 11/14    | FY & SY | Comm. Mtg.         | 3  | 2.a      | Connection, Break Checks                     |
| 12/1       | 1/1      | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 14 | 5.a      | Transition Reflection, Break Info            |
| 12/1       | 1/1      | FY & SY | Comm. Comm.        | 15 | 1.b, 3.b | World of Celebrations                        |
| TBD        | TBD      | FY & SY | Event              | 1  | 1.b, 3.b | World of Celebrations                        |



# Questions?

